

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 4-6

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

S	L	I	C	E
S	M	A	R	T

Ladder 2

S	C	A	R	Y
S	K	I	R	T

Ladder 3

B	L	A	C	K
C	H	E	E	K

Ladder 4

H	A	R	S	H
P	I	N	C	H

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

S	L	I	C	E
S	P	I	C	E
S	P	A	C	E
S	P	A	R	E
S	T	A	R	E
S	T	A	R	T
S	M	A	R	T

Ladder 2

S	C	A	R	Y
S	C	A	R	E
S	C	O	R	E
S	H	O	R	E
S	H	O	R	T
S	H	I	R	T
S	K	I	R	T

Ladder 3

B	L	A	C	K
S	L	A	C	K
S	L	I	C	K
C	L	I	C	K
C	H	I	C	K
C	H	E	C	K
C	H	E	E	K

Ladder 4

H	A	R	S	H
M	A	R	S	H
M	A	R	C	H
M	A	T	C	H
P	A	T	C	H
P	I	T	C	H
P	I	N	C	H